

"Vison Talk"

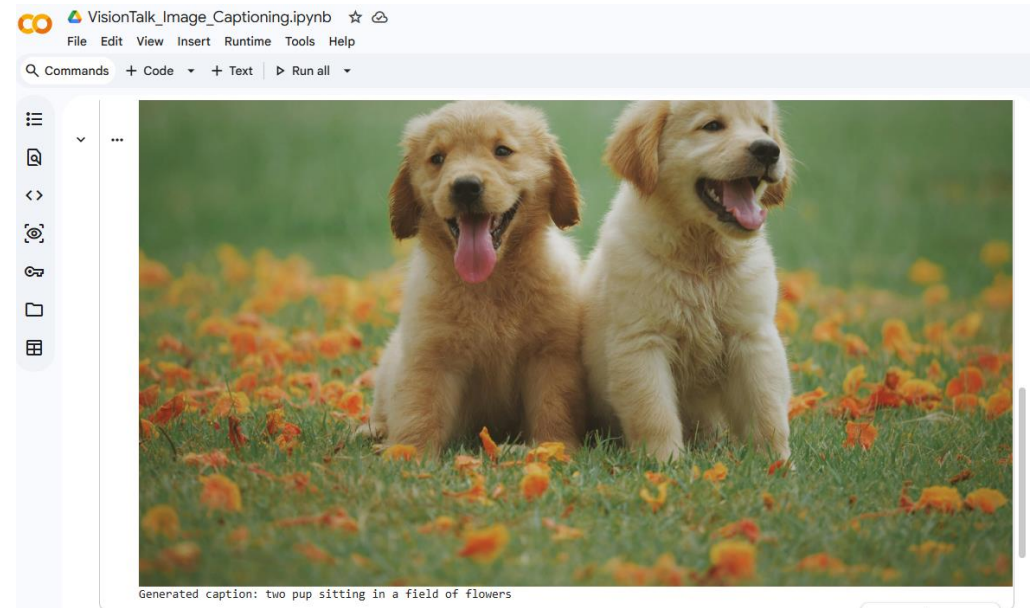
Gregory Livingston

Final Project -Computer Vision (ITAI 1378)

ITAI- 1378

Patricia McManus

12-11-2025



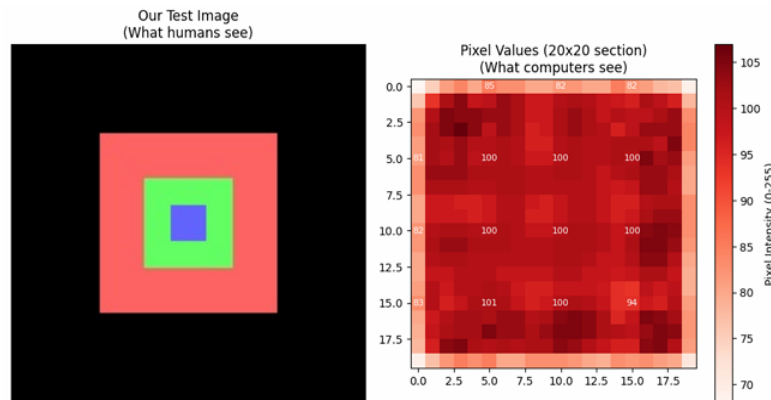
Generated caption: two pup sitting in a field of flowers

 Gregory-Livingston-Applied-AI-Portfolio Public

Portfolio Link: <https://github.com/GregLivin/Gregory-Livingston-Applied-AI-Portfolio>

What "I" Learned

- I learned how computers interpret images using pixel values and color channels.
- I practiced applying image processing techniques such as filtering, edge detection, and thresholding.
- I learned how to use classic machine learning for image classification before moving into deep learning.
- I studied neural networks and how they learn visual patterns.



Key Insight: The image on the left is what we see.
The numbers on the right are what the computer sees!

Exploring RGB Channels

Lecture Connection: We discussed how color images are 3D matrices with separate Red, Green, and Blue channels. Let's separate them and see each channel individually!

```
Generating restval split: 100% 30504/30504 [00:00<00:00, 89207.48 exa  
Keys available in the dataset:  
dict_keys(['filepath', 'sentids', 'filename', 'imgid', 'split', 'sentences', 'cocoid', 'url'])  
Downloading image from: http://images.cocodataset.org/val2014/COCO\_val2014\_000000310391.jpg  
Image loaded! Size: (640, 360)
```

Sample Image from COCO



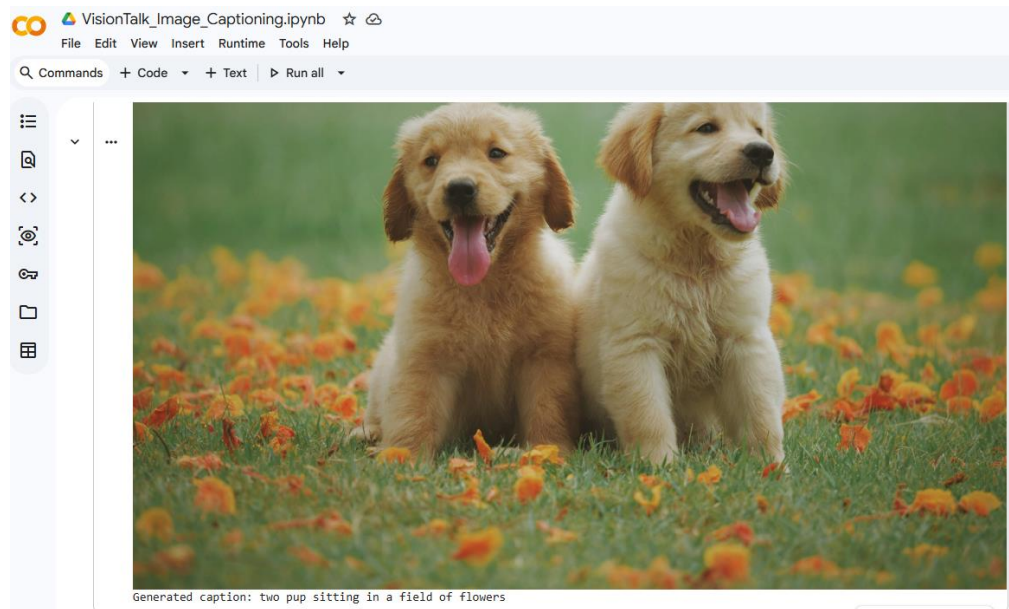
Caption: A car with some surfboards in a field.

- I learned how Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) extract features for image recognition.
- I explored transfer learning and pretrained models for improving performance.
- I learned about Vision Transformers and how attention improves image understanding.
- I studied Vision–Language Models (VLMs) and how they connect images to natural-language generation.

Problem & Solution

Problem:

Images contain a lot of visual information, but without captions, people and systems cannot easily understand the meaning or context.



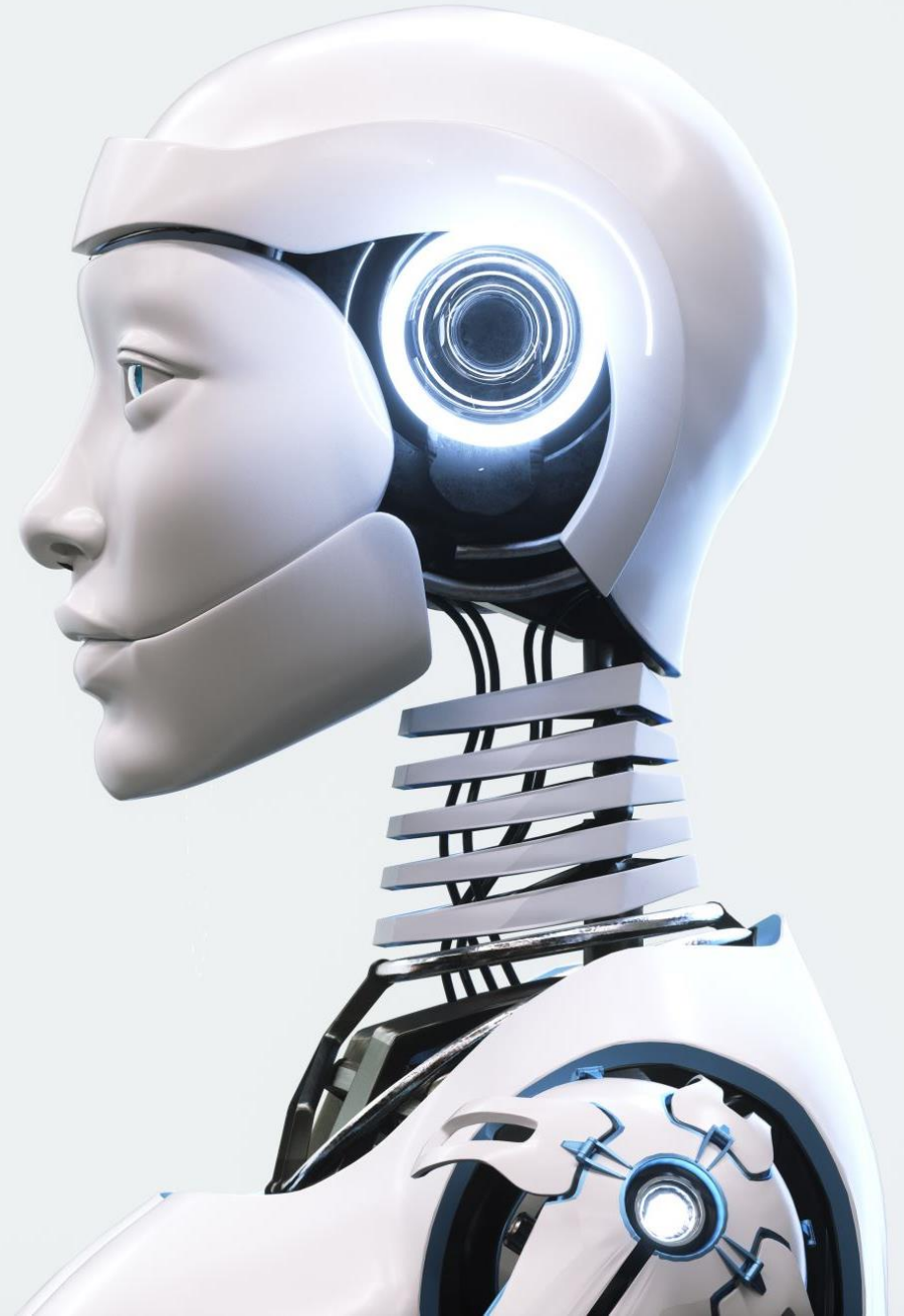
Generated caption: two pup sitting in a field of flowers

Solution:

I built *VisionTalk*, an AI system that uses a pretrained BLIP Vision–Language Model to automatically generate captions from images. This demonstrates how computer vision can connect visual recognition with natural-language processing.

How the System Works

- Uses a pretrained BLIP model from Hugging Face.
- Takes an input image and encodes visual features.
- The language model generates a natural-language caption describing the image.
- Implemented in a Jupyter Notebook with Python and Transformers.
- Results show meaningful and accurate captions.



What I Gained from This Project

- Hands-on experience using Vision–Language Models
- Improved understanding of how AI connects images and text
- Practice organizing and documenting a full AI project
- Stronger coding and notebook development skills
- Added a complete, functional project to my professional AI portfolio